25901576 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026 Fourth SEMESTER MG4DSCTRS200 - TRANSLATION FOR THE MEDIA

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. (d) Earthquake Disaster Report [CO 1]
2. (b) Dubbing director [CO 2]
3. (b) Creative Transformation [CO 3]
4. (b) Interpretive Commentary [CO 4]
5. (b) save time while providing verified information [CO 1]
6. (c). functional and performative adaptation [CO 2]
7. (a) War hero [CO 3]
8. (d) viewing and analysing visual content [CO 4]
9. (b) alignment between text, visuals, sound and brand identity [CO 1]
10. (a) replaced by new recorded voices [CO 2]

(1x10=10)

Part B - SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Plagiarism in journalism is the unethical practice of presenting someone else's ideas, words, or data as one's own without proper acknowledgment. It damages credibility and violates journalistic ethics. Attribution is the practice of clearly identifying the source of information in a news report. It ensures transparency, builds trust, and allows verification. Example: "According to police officials…" or "The report by WHO states…". [CO1]

12. Visuals guide translation decisions in audio-visual media. Translators must ensure that the translated dialogue matches:

- Lip movements (lip-sync) in dubbing
- Timing and duration in subtitles
- Gestures, expressions, and context visible on screen

For example, a character smiling while speaking requires a tone that reflects happiness. Visual cues also reduce the need for verbal explanation, so translations are often shorter and more context-based. [CO2]

13. Najeb's suffering in the desert transforms him both physically and psychologically. Initially an ordinary migrant worker, he endures extreme hardship, isolation, and dehumanization.

This suffering:

- Strips away his previous identity
- Forces him into survival mode
- Builds resilience and inner strength

Ultimately, suffering becomes a means of self-realization, shaping him into a stronger, more introspective individual. [CO3]

14. Audio Storytelling:

- Created for entertainment or narrative (podcasts, radio plays)

- Uses sound effects, music, and narration creatively
- Allows imagination and interpretation

Audio Description:

- Created for accessibility (visually impaired audiences)
- Describes visual elements objectively
- Avoids interpretation and focuses on clarity

  Key Difference: Storytelling is expressive; Audio Description is informative and neutral. [CO4]

15.Headlines may contain pun, idioms and cultural references .

News stories use idioms, jokes,wordplay, and cultural references. Direct translation may sound unnatural or confusing .. Example:“the elephant in the room” translated literally may not convey inflation . It may need an equivalent phrase like “the big problem everyone refuses to talk about” Thus, headlines require adaptation, not word-for-word translation

Political terms may be different- example, the word terrorist” may be rendered as “militant”, “freedom fighter” on the media outlet’s editorial stance [CO1]

16.Subtitling has strict constraints:Limited screen space , Limited reading time , Need for synchronization with speech. Therefore, translators:Condense dialogue , Remove fillers and repetitions , Focus on essential meaning

This results in selective translation, not complete word-for-word rendering. [CO2]

17. Themes in *The Godfather*: (1)Power and Corruption:The film shows how power influences morality and leads to corruption. (2)Family and Loyalty: Loyalty to family is central, often overriding legal, ethical boundaries. (3)Masculitiy and Dominance [CO3]

18. Audio Description began in the late 20th century as a tool for accessibility. It developed through:

- Theatre experiments in the 1970s
- 1980s:expansion of AD into live performance
- Expansion into television and film :1990s (Descriptive Video Service was launched by PBSin 1990
- Institutional support and standardization

  By the end of the century, it became an important accessibility practice in media industries. [CO4]

19.In Bicycle Thieves, the translation from words to images is not mechanical but poetic

- Shot Composition: A low-angle shot can imbue a character with power; a close-up can reveal unspoken emotions.
- Framing and Composition: The recurring wide shots of Rome's streets situate the characters within the social landscape, underscoring the systemic nature of poverty.
- Close-ups bring us into intimate contact with Antonio's growing despair and Bruno's silent resilience, replacing narrative exposition with visual empathy.
- Camera Movement: The tracking shots following Antonio and Bruno through crowded streets mirror the forward drive of the written narrative, but with a sensory dimension - the shuffle of feet, the ambient chatter - that no paragraph could replicate.
- Editing Rhythm: Pacing controls emotional impact - long takes for contemplation and rapid cuts for urgency.
- Sound and Silence: Dialogue, music and silences become narrative devices. Silence carries the weight of a thousand words.
- It captures the emotional core of the original story
- Uses realistic visuals and performances
- Adapts content to suit cinematic storytelling [CO3]

(5x6=30)

Part C - ESSAY
Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20.Audio Description involves a structured process:
1. Viewing and Analysis: The describer watches the content to identify key visual elements like actions, settings, and expressions.
2. Script Writing: Descriptions are written clearly and objectively, fitting into pauses between dialogues.
3. Timing and Synchronisation: Scripts must fit into pauses between dialogues , sound effects
4. Recording: A voice artist records the description in a neutral tone.
5. Integration/ Mixing: The recorded audio is synchronized with the original soundtrack.
6. User Testing and Feedback: Testing the AD with real users- especially people with visual impairments. [CO 4]

21. How cinema uses visuals and sound differently from novels
Cinema and novels tell stories in fundamentally different ways:
Cinema: (a)Uses visual imagery, camera angles, lighting , (b)Employs sound, music, and silence for emotional impact , (c)Shows rather than tells
Novels: (a)Use language and description , (b)Provide inner thoughts and detailed narration , (c)Depend on reader imagination [CO 3]

22. Importance of understanding audio-visual sign systems in translation
Four types of audio-visual signs:Verbal- Acoustic Signs (spoken language), Non-verbal acoustic signs (background music, environmental music, etc), Verbal visual Signs (written words appear on screen as captions text messages, labels, headlines),Non-verbal Visual Signs (facial expressions, camera angles, colour,etc)
Understanding these systems ensures accurate and effective translation. [CO2]

23 (a). Language of news and its features
News language is: Simple and direct, Neutral and impersonal tone, Active voice, Short sentences and paragraph, Concrete and specific
It prioritizes clarity, accuracy, and immediacy.
(b). Adapted News Report (Any clear answer can be awarded marks)
Headline:
Spain Approves New Law to Control Rising Urban Rents
Report:
Madrid, July 22 – Spain's Parliament has approved a new housing reform law aimed at controlling rising rents in major cities, where housing has become increasingly unaffordable. The law allows regional governments to identify high-demand areas and introduce rent limits. It also strengthens protections for tenants.
The government said the move is necessary to support low-income families facing increasing living costs. However, property developers have warned that the new rules may reduce construction activity if profits decline.
The implementation of the law will be managed by regional authorities. [CO1]

(15 x 2 = 30)